Week 1: Foundations of Soft Skills and Communication

NPTEL Soft Skills · Prof. Binod Mishra · Lectures 1–5

Contents

1. Lecture 1: Introduction to Soft Skills
2. Lecture 2: Aspects of Soft Skills
3. Lecture 3: Effective Communication Skills
4. Lecture 4: Classification of Communication
5. Lecture 5: Personality Development

Lecture 1: Introduction to Soft Skills

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 5–23 (printed pages 4–22)

Learning objectives

- Understand what soft skills are and why the term is called an umbrella term.
- Distinguish soft skills from hard skills.
- Explain why soft skills matter for employability and career growth.
- Recall the working definition and the key skills named in the lecture (self-awareness, flexibility, persistence).

Important definitions

SOFT SKILLS

An umbrella term for people skills, life skills and behavioural skills. Working definition: soft skills comprise personality traits, social graces, facility with language, personal habits, friendliness and optimism that mark people to varying degrees.

HARD SKILLS

Subject knowledge and technical expertise gained through college or university study; part of the formal curriculum.

EMPLOYABILITY

The ability to get and keep a job; the lecturer calls it the “keyword”, since degrees alone do not make a person employable.

Core concepts

Soft skills are more than communication skills

Many people think soft skills = communication skills. Communication is only **one part**. Others include interpersonal skills, management skills, leadership skills and team dynamics. Soft skills cannot be learned in a day: they are a **lifelong, continuous learning process**.

The lecturer's two illustrations

- **Gift-shop manager:** a young manager with no degree won the customer by helping, analysing the need, being friendly and reassuring. Another salesman who also spoke did not have the "extra edge", so communication alone is not the answer.
- **Two doctors on one road:** both had foreign degrees and were toppers, yet one clinic was crowded. The difference lay in how they talked to patients, their use of simple language (the doctor who said "hypochondria" confused the patient) and how friendly the staff were.

Behavioural skills the lecture names

- **Self-awareness** – awareness of present-day needs of the world and of one's own abilities.
- **Flexibility**.
- **Persistence and perseverance**.
- Self-confidence, optimism, cultural sensitivity, being accommodating and a good listener.

Why soft skills matter

- They help us come out of difficult situations and give **reassurance and reliability**.
- Two equally qualified people can get different packages because of soft skills.
- Job requirements are changing: employers want people who take initiative, make decisions, negotiate and innovate.
- There is a **gap between academia and industry**; organisations often train new recruits in soft skills.
- Soft skills make an employee more cordial, accountable and able to take decisions without the boss's direction.
- Needed in meetings, group discussions, drafting business documents, telephone deals, electronic writing and representing the organisation.
- In a globalised "global village", cultural sensitivity and listening are essential.

Evidence cited (employability gap)

- Census 2011 data reported by *The Hindu*: unemployment is high among the better qualified.
- Report: 23 lakh people applied for a peon's job in U.P., including engineers and doctors.
- Survey in *Aspiring Minds*: many professionals are unemployable because of poor communication skills.
- Kiran Karnik (former NASSCOM president): we must groom qualified students to make them employable.
- ILO report: India faces "jobless growth"; Rituparna Chakraborty (Vice President, Indian Staffing Federation): "We need to invest in and build skills among the youth."
- Government initiatives mentioned: Skill India, Start-up India, Make in India; NPTEL itself aims to bridge the gap.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Hard skills versus soft skills (as described in the lecture)

Basis	Hard skills	Soft skills
Nature	Subject knowledge, technical expertise	Personality traits, people skills, life skills, behavioural skills
Source	Taught in college curriculum	Not taught as a college subject; learned through exposure, practice and training programmes
Role	Get you the job (technical competence)	Make you excel and shine in the job; "performance skills"
Relationship	Need soft skills to be effective	Complement hard skills: "drive your hard skills through the engine of soft skills"

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SWAMI VIVEKANANDA'S MANTRA — QUOTED IN THE LECTURE

"Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached." Arise = become **self-aware**; awake = become **self-confident**; do not stop = become **dynamic** through soft skills.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Gift-shop manager who lacked an MBA yet persuaded the customer through helpfulness and need analysis.

EXAMPLE

Two doctors with identical foreign degrees: the crowded clinic is the one with better patient dealing and friendlier staff.

EXAMPLE

A recruiter's remark: "I would love to hire a girl with a pleasant smile and better communication skills than one having a very good CGPA and doing nothing."

Comparison tables

Soft skills versus communication skills

Point	Soft skills	Communication skills
Scope	Umbrella term covering many skills	One component of soft skills
Includes	Interpersonal, management, leadership, team dynamics, self-awareness, flexibility, persistence	Speaking, listening, writing, non-verbal communication

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Soft skills is an **umbrella term**; they are also called life skills, people skills and behavioural skills.
- Estimates of the number of soft skills vary (28, 60 or 10) because the skills overlap.
- Working definition: personality traits, social graces, facility with language, personal habits, friendliness and optimism.
- Behavioural skills named first: self-awareness, then flexibility, then persistence and perseverance.
- Soft skills are performance skills and a process of continuous learning.
- Hard skills are part of the college curriculum; soft skills are not taught as a college subject.
- Recruiter quote: pleasant smile and communication skills preferred over a very good CGPA by someone doing nothing.
- Swami Vivekananda's mantra is "Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached."

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q6	p.4	Importance of soft skills in hiring	MCQ
W1 Q11	p.5	Behavioural soft skills	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Soft skills are an umbrella term for people, life and behavioural skills such as self-awareness, flexibility, persistence, friendliness and optimism. They complement hard (technical) skills, make people employable and are learned continuously. Communication is only one part of soft skills. The widening gap between academia and industry, and rising unemployment among qualified people, show why employers value them.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which statement best describes soft skills?

A. Technical expertise gained in college

B. An umbrella term for people, life and behavioural skills

C. Only communication skills

D. Skills taught in every university syllabus

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** The lecture calls soft skills an umbrella term and cautions that they are not merely communication skills.

Q2 (MCQ) Which of these is a hard skill?

A. Persistence

B. Friendliness

C. Technical expertise in a subject

D. Optimism

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Hard skills are subject knowledge and technical expertise.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the behavioural skills named in the lecture.

A. Self-awareness

B. Flexibility

C. Typing speed

D. Persistence and perseverance

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** These are the personal charms listed; typing speed is not mentioned.

Q4 (T/F) Communication skills and soft skills mean exactly the same thing.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Communication is only a part of the wider set of soft skills.

Q5 (Fill) Soft skills are performance skills, while hard skills are part of the _____.

> **Answer:** college curriculum
> **Why:** Soft skills are not taught in colleges the way subject knowledge is.

Q6 (Short) Why were the two doctors in the lecture's example differently successful?

> **Answer:** Their soft skills differed.
> **Why:** One used simple language, took the case history and had friendly staff; the other confused patients with jargon.

Revision checklist

☐ I can state the working definition of soft skills.
☐ I can list three differences between hard and soft skills.
☐ I know why communication skills alone are not soft skills.
☐ I can quote Vivekananda’s mantra and explain its three parts.
☐ I remember the employability evidence (Census 2011, 23 lakh peon applicants, NASSCOM remark).

Lecture 2: Aspects of Soft Skills

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 24–40 (printed pages 23–39)

Learning objectives

- List the main aspects (components) of soft skills: communication, attitude, adaptability, teamwork, conflict management, leadership, time and space skills, mannerism and cultural sensitivity.
- Explain the four communication skills (listening, speaking, reading, writing) and why listening comes first.
- Apply De Bono's Six Thinking Hats to problem solving.
- Recall the quotations and thinkers used in the lecture.

Important definitions

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Communication that serves the requisite purpose (e.g. you order a book and receive it in time). It needs more than words: structure, sentence construction, non-verbal cues and the receiver's point of view.

COMMUNICATION

From the Latin *communicare*, meaning **to share** an idea or experience through a medium.

ATTITUDE

A tendency or willingness displayed to get work done in the right direction and in the right way.

ADAPTABILITY

Ability to adjust to differing situations, tools, versions and ways of working.

HOMOPHILY

Common experiences or familiarity between sender and receiver, which make communication faster and more vital.

CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

Using soft skills to resolve a conflict so that it does not turn into a quarrel; healthy conflict is functional and promotes creative thinking and team decisions.

Core concepts

Aspects of soft skills

1. **Effective communication** – listening, speaking, reading, writing.
2. **Attitude**.
3. **Adaptability**.
4. **Teamwork** and conflict management.
5. **Leadership** – a trait developed over time; leaders emerge from critical situations (e.g. rescue a group discussion from being sidetracked).
6. **Time and space skills** – everyone has only 24 hours; effective managers manage time.
7. **Mannerism** – learnable; organisations look for well-mannered people.
8. **Cultural sensitivity** – respect others' culture, faith and beliefs.
9. **Problem solving** (e.g. Six Thinking Hats).

The four communication skills

- **Listening** – first and most neglected; 60–75 per cent of working time is spent listening. All hearing is not listening: hearing needs no conscious effort, listening is a mental activity (active/perceptive listening).
- **Speaking** – needed in interviews, group discussions, data collection, product launches, negotiations, presentations. A communication starts with a message and ends in a response.
- **Reading** – on the decline because of screens; "Reading maketh a full man".
- **Writing** – the most challenging; business writing is meant **to express and not to impress**; avoid pompous words; follow the organisation's structure.

Attitude: the five Cs to avoid

Organisations suffer from "emotional cancers": **criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing and contending** instead of concentrating on one's own work. ("My shirt is whiter than yours.")

Teamwork and conflict

- Projects come as team projects; a leader should bind, cohere and accommodate different natures.
- Own both defeat and victory: no blame game; say "team's victory".
- Suzanne Bidlake: "In most models of future organization, teams, not individuals function as the primary performance unit."
- David Hume: "Truth springs from argument amongst friends" – let there be argument, not quarrel. Emotions should not enter conflict resolution.
- Advantages of conflict management: functional, healthy, ensures creative thinking and promotes team decisions.

Culture

The lecture quotes "Culture is a code we learn and share" (the transcript says Adam Smith; the quiz attributes the definition to **Alfred G. Smith**, *Communication and Culture*). Accept, accommodate and assimilate; communication should be a binding, not a dividing, force. Not everything in your culture is good, nor everything in another's bad.

Leadership

Not all can be leaders. A leader emerges because of merit and constructive suggestions, builds support logically, and saves the group from deviating. Leadership is developed through awareness and interaction.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Six Thinking Hats (Edward De Bono)

Hat	Thinking mode
White	Objective, facts and information
Red	Emotions and feelings
Yellow	Positive mindset, optimism
Green	Generating ideas, creativity
Blue	Controlling and organising the thinking process
Black	Caution, fighting against and preventing mistakes (not detailed in this lecture's text)

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SIX THINKING HATS — EDWARD DE BONO

A technique for problem solving: when all members take turns wearing different coloured hats, different kinds of ideas emerge, giving more creative and conclusive solutions.

QUOTATIONS TO REMEMBER

- David Hume – "Truth springs from argument amongst friends."
- Suzanne Bidlake – teams, not individuals, are the primary performance unit.
- "Reading maketh a full man."
- Culture is "a code we learn and share" (Alfred G. Smith).

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Missed calls used by youngsters as a code: repeated missed calls lead to confusion, showing communication can fail.

EXAMPLE

Cricket: the captain says "it is the team's victory", not the individual's.

EXAMPLE

In a group discussion a person with no points at first can contribute later if he keeps listening patiently.

Comparison tables

Hearing versus listening

Hearing	Listening
Physiological (physical) activity	Mental activity
Needs no conscious effort	Needs conscious participation and extra effort
Passive	Active/perceptive

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Latin *communicare* = to share.
- 60–75 per cent of one's time in any job is spent in listening.
- Four communication skills: listening, speaking, reading, writing; writing is the most challenging.
- Business writing: express, do not impress.
- Five negative Cs: criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing, contending.
- Green hat = generating ideas; white = objective; red = emotion; yellow = positive; blue = control.
- Hume: truth springs from argument amongst friends.
- Culture is a code we learn and share (Alfred G. Smith in the quiz).
- Homophily = common experience between communicators.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q1	p.3	Hearing vs listening	MCQ
W1 Q3	p.3	De Bono's Six Thinking Hats	MCQ
W1 Q9	p.4	Time spent listening	MCQ
W1 Q13	p.5	De Bono's Six Thinking Hats	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Soft skills have several aspects: effective communication (listening, speaking, reading, writing), attitude, adaptability, teamwork, conflict management, leadership, time and space skills, mannerism and cultural sensitivity. Listening is the foundation; business writing aims to express, not impress. Teams, not individuals, are the performance unit, and constructive conflict helps. De Bono's hats support creative problem solving.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which hat is associated with generating ideas?

A. White

B. Red

C. Green

D. Blue

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Green hat = idea generation.

Q2 (MCQ) The word 'communication' comes from *communicare*, meaning:

A. To speak

B. To share

C. To write

D. To command

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Communication is sharing ideas or experiences.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the four communication skills discussed.

A. Listening

B. Speaking

C. Reading

D. Writing

E. Painting

> **Answer:** A, B, C, D
> **Why:** LSRW are the four skills.

Q4 (T/F) Hearing and listening require the same amount of conscious effort.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Hearing is physical and needs no conscious effort; listening is mental and conscious.

Q5 (Fill) Business writing is meant to express and not to _____.

> **Answer:** impress
> **Why:** Avoid pompous words; be clear.

Q6 (Short) Name the five negative Cs that harm attitude in organisations.

> **Answer:** Criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing and contending.
> **Why:** They replace concentration on one's own work.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the aspects of soft skills.
☐ I know the four communication skills and why listening comes first.
☐ I can match each Six Thinking Hat to its function.
☐ I remember Hume, Bidlake and the culture quotation.
☐ I can state the 60–75 per cent listening fact.

Lecture 3: Effective Communication Skills

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 41–54 (printed pages 40–53)

Learning objectives

- Define communication and explain why it is called a process.
- Describe the elements of the communication process: sender, encoding, message, channel, receiver, decoding, feedback, frame of reference, noise.
- State the qualities of effective communication (the 7 Cs as presented).
- Differentiate general-purpose and organisational communication, and internal and external communication, including the grapevine.

Important definitions

COMMUNICATION

To express an idea, desire, expectation or experience; from Latin *communicare* (to share). It is effective only when it meets its desired goal.

COMMON FRAME OF REFERENCE

Shared background (age, experience, knowledge, tastes) between sender and receiver that makes communication successful.

ENCODING

The sender’s act of putting an idea into a message (words, symbols, language) before sending.

DECODING

The receiver’s act of extracting the meaning from the received message.

FEEDBACK

The receiver’s response; only feedback shows that the communication process is complete.

GRAPEVINE

An informal channel of organisational communication, often a rumour mill; information may be unauthentic or inadequate, though it may also forewarn management.

HOMOPHILY

Common experiences between communicators.

Core concepts

Illusion of communication

George Bernard Shaw: “The greatest problem in communication is the illusion that it has been accomplished.” The real test is whether the message sent has been **received properly**.

Communication as a process

1. The **sender/source** has an idea, experience, desire or fact.
2. The sender considers the receiver’s background, **encodes** the idea in a message and selects a **channel**.
3. The message is transmitted; obstruction (noise, wrong medium, difficult language) may change it.
4. The **receiver decodes** the message.
5. The receiver gives **feedback**, which completes the process.

Absence of a response does not always mean failure; there may be an obstruction.

Factors that affect success

- **Perception** differs between sender and receiver.
- **Environment** (e.g. a noisy marketplace spoils a phone call).
- **Medium** (the teacher who did not have email access); choose a medium the receiver is accustomed to.
- **Language and vocabulary** (Marathi to a Tamil speaker fails; difficult English words fail because nobody sits with a thesaurus).
- Receiver’s attention and background.

Qualities of effective communication (the 7 Cs as presented)

- **Clarity** – be clear and avoid difficult words.
- **Completeness** – no half sentences; written messages cannot be clarified on the spot.
- **Conciseness** – use short sentences yet be specific; the “hallmark of communication”.
- **Correctness** – grammatical and accurate.
- **Courtesy** – consideration and sympathy for the receiver, especially seniors and elders.
- **Candidness** – integrity, honesty and fairness.
- **Consideration** of the receiver’s background and knowledge (the text names the seven but spells out these six plus consideration; the exact seventh appears only in the original slide).

Organisational communication

Differs from casual communication; words must be specific because people of different faiths, beliefs and positions work together. Think of collective responsibility.

- **Internal** – within the organisation: formal (meetings, policies) and informal. Flow: **upward, downward, horizontal (lateral), vertical, diagonal/across departments**.
- **External** – with clients, customers, government agencies and the public; builds a positive image (promotion, website, pamphlets, letters, internet).

The grapevine

Formal communication is to the point, so employees seek an informal channel. Grapevine information is often unauthentic and can create factionalism; managers sometimes use it carefully for early warnings. Use it not to discard or discredit, and stay away from rumour.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Direction of internal communication

Direction	Meaning / example
Downward	From management to employees (new policy, DA hike)
Upward	From employees to superiors (feedback, requests)
Horizontal / lateral	Between people of the same status or post
Diagonal / across departments	Between different departments and levels

Theories, principles, models and contributors

PROCESS MODEL OF COMMUNICATION

Sender (idea) → encode → channel → receiver → decode → feedback. A common frame of reference and absence of noise help it succeed.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A child who cries when hungry communicates without words; only the mother knows the cause.

EXAMPLE

Sharing a book or movie is easiest with a friend of similar age, experience and knowledge.

EXAMPLE

An email sent to a teacher who has no email access never gets a response; a phone call fixes it.

Comparison tables

General-purpose versus organisational communication

Point	General-purpose (casual)	Organisational
Participants	Friends and relatives	Employees at different positions, clients, public
Language	Casual, loose word control	Specific, careful, considers beliefs and positions
Aim	Social sharing	Specific organisational goal

Internal versus external communication

Internal	External
Within the organisation and with employees	With clients, customers, government agencies, the public
Formal and informal (incl. grapevine)	Product promotion, website, letters; builds image

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Bernard Shaw: the greatest problem in communication is the illusion that it has been accomplished.
- Communication is a process; feedback completes it.
- A common frame of reference is essential for success.
- Conciseness is the hallmark of communication.
- Grapevine = informal channel, often rumour-based and not always authentic; it may be used carefully.
- Internal flow: upward, downward, horizontal, vertical, diagonal.
- Extracting meaning from a message is decoding; forming it is encoding.
- Latin *communicare* = to share.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q5	p.3	Frame of reference in communication	MCQ
W1 Q7	p.4	Meaning of communication	MCQ
W1 Q10	p.4	Encoding and decoding	MCQ
W1 Q12	p.5	Seven Cs of communication	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Communication is a process in which a sender encodes an idea, sends it through a channel, the receiver decodes it, and feedback completes the cycle. A shared frame of reference, a suitable medium and environment, and a message that is clear, complete, concise, correct, courteous and candid improve effectiveness. Organisational communication may be internal (upward, downward, horizontal, diagonal, including the grapevine) or external.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The receiver's task of extracting meaning from a message is called:

A. Encoding

B. Decoding

C. Feedback

D. Channelling

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Receivers decode; senders encode.

Q2 (MCQ) Shared background of experience between sender and receiver is the:

A. Common frame of reference

B. Grapevine

C. Channel

D. Feedback loop

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** It makes communication successful and effective.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are directions of internal communication?

A. Upward

B. Downward

C. Horizontal

D. Subterranean

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Diagonal is also mentioned; 'subterranean' is not.

Q4 (T/F) The grapevine always gives authentic information.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It is informal and may be rumour-based and inadequate.

Q5 (Fill) Communication is complete only when _____ is received.

> **Answer:** feedback
> **Why:** Feedback shows the process has been completed.

Q6 (Short) Name two factors that can obstruct a message.

> **Answer:** Noise in the environment and an unsuitable medium or language.
> **Why:** Perception differences also matter.

Revision checklist

☐ I can draw and explain the communication process.
☐ I can explain the Shaw quotation.
☐ I know the qualities of effective communication.
☐ I can distinguish internal, external and grapevine communication.
☐ I know the directions of internal communication.

Lecture 4: Classification of Communication

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 55–69 (printed pages 54–68)

Learning objectives

- Compare oral and written communication.
- Classify communication by number of participants: intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group and mass/media.
- Explain verbal, non-verbal and meta-communication, and print vs electronic media.
- Understand cross-cultural, ethical and legal aspects (plagiarism, libel, slander).

Important definitions

INTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication within oneself: you talk to yourself; the eyes act as transmitter, the central nervous system as medium and the brain as receiver, with feedback in bodily reactions. Helps self-discovery and recovery.

INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication between two individuals (or two groups), usually conversation or dialogue; also called **dyadic** communication and 'relationship communication'.

EXTRA-PERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication between humans and animals (or animals among themselves) without language; responses come through movements and sounds.

GROUP COMMUNICATION

Communication among members of a group (classroom lecture, group discussion, meeting).

MASS AND MEDIA COMMUNICATION

Communication to large audiences through electrical and mechanical devices (newspaper, television); receivers are largely passive.

META-COMMUNICATION

Communication beyond words, including unintentional meanings that listeners find in what is said.

LIBEL AND SLANDER

Criticism of an organisation or person in writing is **libel**; in speech it is **slander**. Both are unethical and may be illegal.

PLAGIARISM

Using someone's words or ideas without acknowledgment; to be avoided with misquoting.

Core concepts

Oral and written communication

- **Oral:** spontaneous, warm, immediate feedback and clarification, uses voice to carry emotion, can be informal or formal, reaches small or large groups; forms include briefing, talk, speech, group discussion, paper presentation, meetings, interviews and telephone.
- **Written:** organised, formal, a record; feedback is delayed; follows standards of grammar and structure; cannot be easily changed once sent; can reach a very large audience across the world. Business writing includes letters, reports, memos, notices, newsletters, circulars, brochures and research papers.

Four forms by number of participants

Humans communicate in four (five) ways depending on the number of participants: **intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group** and **mass/media**.

- Intrapersonal examples: soliloquy and aside in plays (Hamlet's "To be or not to be").
- Interpersonal depends on the relationship with the other party (e.g. boss). Interviews are interpersonal.
- Group: silence in a meeting also communicates.
- Mass/media: less chance of clarification and less personal rapport; sender cannot control a wide audience.

Verbal, non-verbal and meta-communication

- All spoken or written communication is **verbal** (uses words). Meaning lies with the **sender**, not the word.
- **Non-verbal** cues supplement words (body movements, face); the lecture says there are more than **6 lakh** non-verbal cues. "Whatever you say is written on your face."
- **Meta-communication** is beyond words and may carry unintended meaning.

Print and electronic media

Written words keep their importance in print and electronic form (email, chat). Think before writing: messages can be interpreted differently and may have impact in a crisis.

Cross-cultural communication

- Respect religious sentiments, etiquette, tastes, habits and the concept of time.
- In Latin America meetings may start late because people first discuss and eat.
- Gifts: giving a Chinese person a clock may suggest inviting evil.
- Do not assume your culture's understanding is universal; allow room to receivers; mind status patterns.

Ethical and legal aspects

- Every organisation has an ethical code and policy statements; employees must respect them (e.g. using organisational funds to travel for a personal interview is unethical).
- Avoid misquoting, plagiarism and inaccurate information; acknowledge sources.
- Do not criticise your organisation to get another job; remember you are its ambassador.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Classification of human communication by participants

Type	Parties	Key features / examples
Intrapersonal	One person (self)	Self-talk, soliloquy; self-discovery; brain gives feedback
Interpersonal (dyadic)	Two persons or two groups	Conversation, dialogue, interview; depends on relationship
Extra-personal	Humans and animals	Sounds, movements, wagging tails; no language
Group	Members of a group	Lecture, GD, meeting; formalities; silence also communicates
Mass and media	One source to a large audience	Newspaper, TV; passive receiver; little personal rapport

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A student who missed a good grade talks to himself and realises the lapses: intrapersonal communication.

EXAMPLE

Hamlet's soliloquy "To be or not to be, that is the question."

EXAMPLE

Presenting a clock to a Chinese colleague may be read as inviting evil.

EXAMPLE

Latin American meetings begin after discussion and food.

Comparison tables

Oral versus written communication

Point	Oral	Written
Feedback	Immediate, spontaneous	Delayed
Nature	Informal or formal; emotional through voice	Formal, organised, record
Clarification	Possible on the spot	Difficult
Revision	Can improvise	Hard to change once sent
Reach	Small or large group present	Wide audience across the world

Libel versus slander

Libel	Slander
Defamatory statement in writing	Defamatory statement in speech

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Interpersonal communication is also called dyadic communication.
- Intrapersonal: brain acts as receiver; soliloquy and aside are examples.
- Mass/media receivers are passive; media include newspapers and television.
- More than 6 lakh non-verbal cues exist.
- Meaning lies with the sender, not in words.
- Written criticism = libel; spoken = slander.
- A clock as a gift may be considered bad omen in Chinese culture.
- Latin American meetings often start late after discussion and food.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Communication may be oral or written and, by participants, intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group or mass/media. It is also verbal, non-verbal or meta-communication, carried in print or electronic media, and shaped by culture, ethics and law. Effective communicators avoid plagiarism, libel and slander and communicate ‘to bind, not to divide’.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which form of communication is also called dyadic?

A. Intrapersonal

B. Interpersonal

C. Mass

D. Group

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It involves two parties.

Q2 (MCQ) A defamatory spoken remark is called:

A. Libel

B. Slander

C. Plagiarism

D. Soliloquy

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Written = libel; spoken = slander.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the examples of mass communication.

A. Newspaper

B. Television programme

C. A conversation between two friends

D. Talking to oneself

> **Answer:** A, B
> **Why:** They reach large audiences through devices.

Q4 (T/F) In written communication, feedback is usually immediate.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Feedback in writing is delayed.

Q5 (Fill) Soliloquies and asides are examples of _____ communication.

> **Answer:** intrapersonal
> **Why:** The speaker talks to himself.

Q6 (Short) Give two advantages of oral over written communication.

> **Answer:** Spontaneity and immediate feedback and clarification.
> **Why:** Voice also conveys emotion.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the five forms by number of participants.
☐ I can compare oral and written communication.
☐ I know what meta-communication means.
☐ I can distinguish libel, slander and plagiarism.
☐ I can give cross-cultural examples from the lecture.

Lecture 5: Personality Development

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 70–83 (printed pages 69–82)

Learning objectives

- Explain the origin and meaning of ‘personality’ and why outward appearance does not define it.
- Describe Freud’s three systems of personality: id, ego and superego, and their principles.
- Explain Alfred Adler’s ideas: social interest, fictional finalism, striving for superiority, inferiority complex and creative self.
- Compare Freud and Adler and relate personality to workplace behaviour.

Important definitions

PERSONALITY

From Latin *persona*, meaning **mask**. A set of qualities that make an individual distinct: emotional qualities, attitudes, values, beliefs, motivations, communication skills, ways of thinking and behaviour. Personality is an ‘inside thing’.

ID

The reservoir of instinctive energy; the true psychic reality and matrix of the ego and superego; a world of subjective experience that operates on the **pleasure principle** and cannot tolerate tension.

EGO

The executive of the personality and the organised portion of the id; follows the **reality principle**, differentiates memory and image and mediates between instincts and the environment.

SUPEREGO

The moral guardian or moral agency; the internal representative of good and evil; strives for **perfection rather than pleasure** and opposes both id and ego.

FICTIONAL FINALISM

Adler’s idea that humans are guided by hypotheses or ‘fictions’ that cannot be tested (e.g. ‘honesty is the best policy’, ‘the end justifies the means’) but help them deal with reality.

INFERIORITY COMPLEX / STRIVING FOR SUPERIORITY

Every human feels some inferiority and compensates by striving for superiority, i.e. perfection.

Core concepts

What personality is not

Good looks, dress or fluency are only **outward features**. Shakespeare: “One may smile and smile and be a villain.” Two people who look identical may think very differently.

Why personality matters at work

- Helps understand the mindset of people from different backgrounds and faiths.
- Develops flexibility, persuasion, compassion and diplomacy.
- Builds competence and career success; explains why people react the way they do.

Freud’s three systems

- **Id** – pleasure principle; does not distinguish right from wrong; relieves tension through **reflex action** (sneezing, blinking) and **primary process / wish fulfilment** (e.g. a hungry person imagines food; repressed wishes appear in dreams – *Interpretation of Dreams*).
- **Ego** – reality principle; asks whether an experience is true or false; finds realistic ways (how to get food); mediates between id and environment.
- **Superego** – moral guardian; ideal rather than real; persuades the ego to substitute **moralistic goals for realistic goals**; inhibits impulses.

Every action passes through these three layers. “The child is the father of the man”: childhood habits and social influences continue; thwarted psychological growth can lead to introversion, pessimism or depression.

Alfred Adler’s theory (opposed Freud)

- Humans are primarily **social** creatures, not sexual ones; **social interest** motivates behaviour.
- Personality is shaped by **expectations of the future**, not only past experience.
- **Fictional finalism** guides conduct.
- **Striving for superiority** = striving for perfection; the inferiority complex drives compensation.
- Humans **identify** with others (Freud’s term for imitation).
- Each person has a unique **style of life**; “Le style, c’est l’homme” – the style is the man.
- **Masculine protest**: both men and women seek power.
- People can become a **creative self** and socially useful.
- Example: Mariyappan Thangavelu, Paralympic gold medallist, compensated for a damaged leg. Adler himself was a sickly child who became a doctor.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Freud's three systems of personality

System	Principle	Nature	Function
Id	Pleasure principle	Psychological (psychic) force; subjective	Wants immediate satisfaction; reflex and wish fulfilment
Ego	Reality principle	Biological; executive of personality	Realistic thinking; mediates between id and surroundings
Superego	Perfection / morality	Moralistic force; moral guardian	Opposes id and ego; seeks ideal and right

Theories, principles, models and contributors

FREUD'S PSYCHOANALYTIC STRUCTURE OF PERSONALITY — SIGMUND FREUD

Personality = id + ego + superego. Behaviour results from their interaction, often at an unconscious level.

INDIVIDUAL PSYCHOLOGY — ALFRED ADLER

Social interest, fictional finalism, striving for superiority, creative self.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A hungry person imagines food (id, wish fulfilment); the ego plans how to get food; the superego checks whether it is morally right.

EXAMPLE

A gruff person may hide great kindness; a smiling person may be cruel.

EXAMPLE

Mariyappan Thangavelu turned a physical weakness into Paralympic success.

Comparison tables

Freud versus Adler

Point	Freud	Adler
Human nature	Driven by instincts (sexual); id, ego, superego	Social creature; social interest
Time orientation	Past experience and childhood	Expectations of the future
Goal	Pleasure and relief of tension	Perfection / superiority
Key terms	Id, ego, superego, wish fulfilment, identification	Fictional finalism, inferiority complex, creative self

Id, ego and superego

Id	Ego	Superego
Pleasure principle	Reality principle	Perfection (moral) principle
Pleasurable or painful?	True or false?	Right or wrong?

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- *Persona* = mask.
- Id: pleasure principle, true psychic reality, matrix of ego and superego.
- Ego: executive of the personality and organised portion of the id; reality principle.
- Superego: strives for perfection rather than pleasure; opposes both id and ego; moral guardian.
- Id relieves tension by reflex action and wish fulfilment.
- Freud's book: *Interpretation of Dreams*.
- Adler: fictional finalism, striving for superiority, creative self, social interest.
- "The child is the father of the man"; "Le style, c'est l'homme."
- Shakespeare: one may smile and smile and be a villain.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q2	p.3	Freud's theory of personality	MCQ
W1 Q4	p.3	Meaning of personality	MCQ
W1 Q14	p.5	Freud's id, ego and superego	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Personality (from *persona*, mask) is the inner set of qualities, attitudes, values and behaviours that make people distinct. Freud explained it through the id (pleasure), ego (reality) and superego (perfection). Adler, opposing Freud, stressed social interest, fictional finalism and striving for superiority, with the possibility of becoming a creative self.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The id operates on the:

A. Reality principle

B. Pleasure principle

C. Moral principle

D. Social principle

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** The ego follows reality; the superego follows perfection.

Q2 (MCQ) Who proposed ‘fictional finalism’?

A. Freud

B. Hume

C. Adler

D. Shakespeare

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Alfred Adler.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the correct statements about the superego.

A. It is the moral guardian

B. It strives for perfection rather than pleasure

C. It supports only the id

D. It opposes both id and ego

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** It does not support the id.

Q4 (T/F) Personality is derived from the Latin word meaning ‘mind’.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It comes from *persona*, meaning mask.

Q5 (Fill) The executive of the personality is the _____.

> **Answer:** ego
> **Why:** It is also the organised portion of the id.

Q6 Short State two differences between Freud and Adler.

> **Answer:** Freud stresses instincts and the past; Adler stresses social interest and future expectations.
> **Why:** Adler also introduced the creative self.

Revision checklist

☐ I can explain the origin of the word personality.
☐ I can describe id, ego and superego with their principles.
☐ I can state Adler’s key ideas.
☐ I can contrast Freud and Adler.
☐ I remember the quotations and the Thangavelu example.